

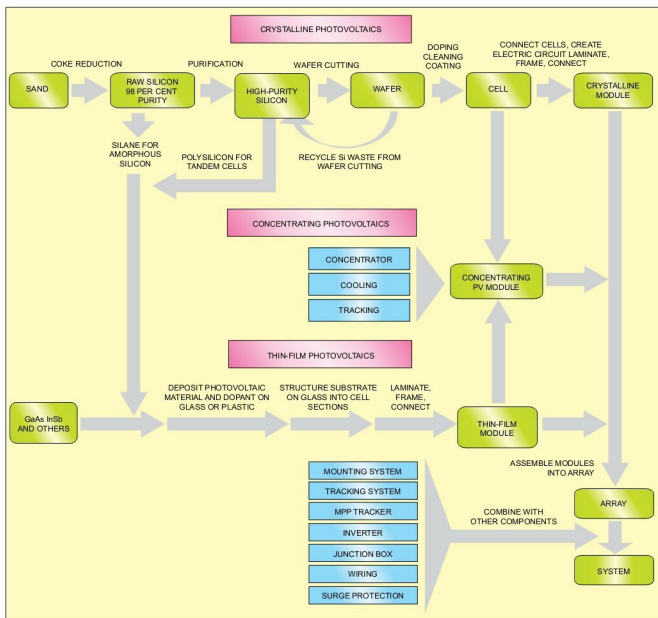


Fig. 2: Solar PV value chain (Courtesy: www.eai.in)

than if manufactured with thin-film technology.

Guidelines for Phase 2 of the JNNSM stipulate that the cSi modules have to contain indigenously produced cells. "Project developers, however, are importing and using thin-film modules as these also provide higher energy yields than cSi modules in the arid and semi-arid climate of India," say S.R.C. Sathyanarayan, head-PV Power Plants, TUV Rheinland (I).

The National Solar Mission gives preference to domestic manufactur-

In the entire solar PV value chain, Indian companies are active only in cell and module manufacturing with no vertical integration. This makes their cells and modules costlier than products from Chinese counterparts

ers only at the central level. States are not obliged to follow this policy. Also, the provision is made under a scheme only. Project developers are free to choose products. Obviously, they go for imported products, which are low-priced and also generally good in quality.

Necessary steps

Indian manufacturers are lobbying for protection against imports from rivals including First Solar and Suntech. They are seeking a 15 per cent tariff to be imposed on imports of